



Latin 3 Honors

COURSE 0706320 • GRADE 11 • HONORS • TWO SEMESTERS • OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE — FAMILY COURSE OVERVIEW

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. It was drawn from one section of the course as taught this year, and each teacher leans into their own strengths and passions — so scholars may see some variation in activities, projects, and pacing from section to section, and between the live school and On-Demand. The structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

What this course is: An honors course for experienced Latin students that moves decisively from grammar into the great authors. After a complete grammar review anchored by a standing reference library, students spend the year with authentic classical texts: Homer's *Odyssey* and the oratory of Cicero in Semester 1; Caesar's *Gallie War*, Plutarch, ancient biography, and the Stoic philosophy of Seneca in Semester 2 — finishing with an introduction to hermeneutics, the art of interpreting texts. Latin etymology runs as a weekly thread connecting it all to English.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE

Start	Course opener; grammar-archive review and digital parsing/dictionary tools; intro to etymology
Sem 1	The <i>Odyssey</i> : Ulysses, the Trojan War, Lotus-eaters & Polyphemus
Sem 1	Cicero & rhetoric: <i>De Oratore</i> , Rostra week, passage analyses, invective & encomium • Quizzes 1 & 2
Sem 2	Caesar's <i>Gallie War</i> & the Gauls; Plutarch • ancient-biography writing exercise • translation week
Sem 2	The Senecas: <i>On the Shortness of Life</i> and Seneca on old age — Stoic philosophy in Latin
Finish	Hermeneutics intro; cumulative wrap-up • End-of-Year Assessment

THE REFERENCE LIBRARY

- **Grammar Archive** — 22 always-available pages: all declensions, conjugations, cases, voice, and mood.
- **Vocabulary Archive** — vocabulary lists and memory work, organized by declension and theme.
- **Digital Parsing & Translation Aids** — the online dictionaries and parsing tools of a working classicist.

A TYPICAL WEEK

- **A passage study** from the current author — reading, translating, analyzing
- **An etymology assignment** tracing the week's Latin into English
- **A reflection or rhetoric exercise** — including a delivered persuasive argument in the Cicero unit
- Steady use of the **reference archives** for grammar support
- Periodic **reviews, quizzes**, and a quarter survey

TIME COMMITMENT

≈4 hours per week (250 minutes — about 50 min/day, M–F)

Author readings & translation ≈2 hr • written analysis & rhetoric ≈1 hr • etymology & vocabulary ≈1 hr

Per-part split is an estimate; the 250-minute weekly total comes from the school's course plan. Writing and translation weeks may run longer.

WHAT STUDENTS NEED

- A computer with access to Canvas (all work is submitted there)
- Free online Latin dictionaries/parsing tools (linked inside the course)
- No textbook purchase required — readings are provided in the course

On-Demand (asynchronous): This overview describes the self-paced experience the course is designed for — students work through lessons on their own schedule with an Optima teacher available for support, feedback, and grading.

Live school: Students enrolled in the live virtual school take this same course in VR every school day with a teacher and classmates.